



INDIA'S BATTING STRATEGY MIRRORED KKR'S 2024 APPROACH, WHERE GAUTAM GAMBHIR WAS INVOLVED AS MENTOR BEFORE BECOMING INDIA'S COACH

composed figure on the field through his debut series as full-time captain, giving his bowlers the freedom to get the job done, as vouched by Axar and Ravi Bishnoi during the series.

Excluding the final T20I, where the team experimented with its batting order and fielded a heavily rotated side, India's victory was primarily based on an aggressive batting strategy. This strategy resembled the approach of Kolkata Knight Riders (KKR) from IPL 2024, the team that Gambhir was previously involved with before taking over as the Indian coach from Rahul Dravid.

Like KKR earlier this year, India attacked early with its openers and maintained an aggressive approach with the middle order, focusing on aggression rather than consolidation.

India's eight-man batting order included four left-handed options,

on display throughout the series, albeit in subtler ways. In the first game, India was in a spot of bother as Pathum Nissanka led Sri Lanka in a record-breaking chase of 214. However, the calm Indian captain used Axar's left-arm spin to dismiss right-hander Nissanka for a 48-ball 79, triggering a collapse that saw the host side lose nine wickets for 30 runs.

The 33-year-old Suryakumar was a

Rewarding partnership: India's T20 World Cup title defence at home in 2026, under new head coach Gautam Gambhir and skipper Suryakumar Yadav, has started on a positive note.

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